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Workforce Engagement Management (WEM) covers the software that schedules, measures, coaches and assists contact-centre staff, and increasingly the AI agents working beside them.

This week's main developments

- Sierra and Meta launched an open standard for how customers' personal AI agents deal with businesses. Genesys is a named partner; Salesforce is not.
- Lorikeet, which sells AI customer-service agents, launched a tool that builds staff rosters. It says the tool can also fix the live schedule by itself; we could not confirm that has shipped.
- Fin launched Fin 4 and says it averages a 76% resolution rate. A Fin page published two days later gives 67%.
- Automation Anywhere agreed to buy Boost.ai, a chat and voice AI vendor, from Nordic Capital. No price was disclosed.
- Colorado's revised draft rules leave summaries and routing tools alone, but presume that a score shown to a manager influenced a promotion decision.
- Revelio Labs says global call-centre employment has fallen year on year for eight straight quarters. Concentrix expects its revenue to shrink.

Sierra and Meta launch a standard for personal AI agents

- Sierra and Meta announced the Personal Agent Protocol on 6 October. It sets how a customer's own AI agent signs in and acts with a business.
- Sierra names Genesys, Instinct, Rocket, Shopify, Stripe and Walmart as partners. CMSWire reports that Meta's list also names NiCE and Decagon.
- The customer chooses whether their agent gets read-only or write access. The personal agent identifies itself, so the business knows when an agent acts for a customer.
- On 9 October Sierra published a draft, called Poppy, and added 35 design partners. They include OpenAI, Zendesk, Bank of America and Visa.
- Decagon released its own consent protocol, PACT, with Instinct on 6 October. Decagon also joined Sierra's working group.
- Sierra says a model it launched on 8 October detects when a phone caller is another AI agent.
- Genesys's chief executive, Tony Bates, said: "Personal AI is creating a new front door to the enterprise."
- Salesforce is on neither partner list. On 9 October it argued that personal agents "are only as reliable as the business agents waiting to greet them at the front door."
- **Our view:** a contact-centre platform joined a standard led by an AI-agent startup. The standard settles identity and permission, not whose agent answers.

- **Why it matters:** Sierra says personal agents that fail on a website "may call the company's support line or open its web chat." Those contacts land on contact-centre platforms.
- **Watch:** the first version of the specification, which Sierra plans to publish later in October.

An AI-agent vendor starts scheduling the human team

- Lorikeet launched Workforce Manager on 7 October. It builds rosters from ticket and call volume, then checks every shift against working rules before publishing.
- It is built for support teams of 20 or more agents on chat or phones. It shows staffing shortfalls up to 12 months ahead.
- Lorikeet said that "by 9 October" the tool would manage the day as it happens. For each type of event, customers choose: notify, propose a fix, or "apply the fix itself."
- We could not confirm that the live-schedule feature has shipped. The tool has no published price and no named customer.
- Lorikeet says it is building a product "that manages your human team and your AI agents together."
- Aspect's public roadmap lists automatic real-time schedule updates as "Exploring." Its August product preview said the software "recommends" changes.
- **Our view:** this is the first offer in our coverage of software changing the live schedule by itself. It comes from an AI-agent vendor, not a scheduling specialist.
- **Watch:** whether Lorikeet's live-schedule mode ships, at what price, and with which customers.

Other workforce management moves

- **Cisne:** hired Jim Nystrom, formerly head of global sales at Five9, as chief revenue officer on 5 October. Cisne sells one system that plans people and AI agents together.
- **Assembled:** said on 1 October that its AI chat agent now hands customers to live chat only during the human team's scheduled hours. Otherwise it offers email.

Fin 4: new scale figures that do not match

- Fin, formerly Intercom and owned by Salesforce since 10 September, launched Fin 4 on 7 October. It adds proactive onboarding and a confidence score for human review.
- Fin says it has 12,000 customers and resolves more than 10 million conversations a month, at a 76% average resolution rate.
- A Fin learning page dated 9 October says the average across all customers is 67%, with early-stage teams at 76%.
- Fin says it sees "a very clear path" to a future in which 90 to 95% of customer communication "will not involve a human."

- Its price stays $0.99 per outcome. The Pro add-on rose from $99 to $100 a month.
- **Our view:** Fin's two pages differ by nine points within two days. We cite its figures only with the page and date.

Automation Anywhere agrees to buy Boost.ai

- Automation Anywhere, a business-process automation company, agreed on 7 October to buy Boost.ai from Nordic Capital. Terms were not disclosed.
- Boost.ai sells chat and voice AI agents and agent assist, mainly to European banks, telecoms and insurers.
- SiliconANGLE reports Boost.ai has about 600 live AI agents and more than 150 million automated conversations. Closing is expected in the fourth quarter.
- It is Automation Anywhere's second such purchase, after Aisera, which automates employee service, in late 2025.
- **Our view:** an automation company buying a customer-facing AI vendor is a new exit route for mid-sized specialists, beside the large contact-centre suites.

Other deals and funding

- **TCN and Abstrakt:** TCN told Abstrakt customers on 7 October they now get one TCN bill. Abstrakt's tools will later merge into TCN's platform; "full native integration will take time."
- **Flyle:** this contact-centre AI agent company raised a ¥1.88 billion (about $12.6 million) Series A, FinTech Observer reports. Salesforce Ventures took part.
- **Genesys and Pinkfish (late catch):** Genesys bought Pinkfish on 30 June, CMSWire reports. Pinkfish connects AI agents to about 25,000 tools. Terms were not disclosed.

Colorado revises its automated-decision rules

- Colorado's Attorney General posted a revised draft of its automated-decision rules on 6 October. Comments close on 26 October, the hearing date. The rules start on 1 January 2027.
- Tools used only to summarise, organise, translate, draft or route information for human review fall outside the rules.
- In the draft's promotion example, a manager sees each candidate's score. The score is presumed to have influenced the decision because the manager was shown it.
- The state asks commenters for alternatives to that presumption.
- In another example, two human reviewers check a promotion tool's recommendation. The employer must still give a disclosure when the outcome is adverse.
- Chatbots handling narrow tasks, such as order status, billing questions or booking appointments, fall outside the chatbot rules.

- The state gave no formal grace period. It says the Attorney General focuses on “egregious and intentional violations.”
- **Our view:** in Colorado, quality and performance scores that managers see before people decisions will need documented human judgment. Summaries and routing do not.

California’s emotion-AI ban

- In a 7 October note, the law firm Epstein Becker Green names “call-center sentiment analysis” among the “likeliest trouble spots” under California’s ban.
- It advises applying the ban to all workers of a California employer until there is further guidance.
- We found no vendor renaming, limiting or removing an emotion feature. No California agency has issued guidance.

Fewer contact-centre jobs, strained outsourcers

- Revelio Labs reported on 6 October that global call-centre employment is 5.3% below its December 2023 peak. Its figures are modelled from online professional profiles.
- Employment has fallen year on year for eight straight quarters. Revelio says these are the only eight falls in 70 quarterly readings since 2009.
- In 12 middle-income countries, call-centre jobs stalled after ChatGPT while other office jobs grew. Revelio says it “cannot observe which firms replace people with chatbots.”
- Concentrix, one of the largest outsourcers, expects fourth-quarter revenue to fall 3% to 5% at constant currency. It reported on 29 September.
- It also took a $1.05 billion goodwill charge, which it links to its share price. Its chief executive said: “we are aggressively disrupting our own traditional business.”
- TTEC’s lenders cut its credit line to $960 million, it filed on 7 October. Its loan margin over the benchmark rate rises from 3.25 to 6.25 percentage points on 16 November unless amended again.
- 3M is moving customer service to global hubs, starting with Manila, the Star Tribune reports. In July its chief executive said an outside provider will run it “using automation and AI.”
- **Against:** Challenger says AI was cited for about 9% of US job cuts in September, against about 21% so far this year.
- HubSpot cut about 660 jobs on 6 October. Its chief executive said the cuts were “not driven by AI-related efficiencies.”
- ISG reports outsourced business-process contract value rose 12% in the third quarter, according to Outsource Accelerator.
- A French consent law for telemarketing calls, not AI, cost an estimated 15,000 call-centre jobs in Morocco and Tunisia, union estimates show.
- **Our view:** the evidence of fewer human seats is growing, but employers rarely name AI as the cause.

Quality scoring covers people and bots

- IDC, an analyst firm, says some conversation-analytics vendors "are refocusing on providing AI agents instead." It named no vendors. Genesys quoted IDC on 6 October.
- Amazon Connect now suggests rewording quality-review questions so AI can score them reliably. Amazon says this helps score "human and AI agents fairly" (9 October).
- Microsoft's quality tool can now run recurring, bulk and sampled reviews, not only one check when a conversation closes. Its roadmap marks this launched in October.
- At its 7 and 8 October event, Parloa introduced a "Relationship Score" out of 100 for AI-handled conversations, built from more than 50 AI-judged checks.
- Parloa says older measures such as customer satisfaction, handle time and containment "say little about how the conversation actually felt." It announced no price or customer figures.
- Zenarate put its 1 October rebrand on the newswire on 8 October. It now measures success by "did the problem get solved?" across human and AI contacts.
- Zenarate reports TruGreen cut onboarding time by 50% and Sallie Mae cut staff turnover by 32%. These are vendor figures.
- **Our view:** quality measurement is moving to one standard for people and bots, and platforms and AI-agent vendors are building it.

Pricing: no move back to seats

- No tracked vendor moved from per-resolution pricing back to per-seat pricing. We re-read nine public price pages on 10 October.
- Fin's Pro add-on rose by $1 a month, its only change. Other prices were unchanged.
- Microsoft says its Sales Development Agent will start using paid Copilot credits on 16 November. Its new autonomous Service Agent is in private preview.
- Sierra restated at its 6 October summit that customers "pay for results, not tokens." It publishes no price list.
- Salesforce's contact-centre service still lists every non-US price as "Not currently available in this region" (10 October).
- HubSpot's chief executive says its move to "delivering outcomes for them with AI" is transforming its pricing. It announced no price change.

A live deployment, with a limit

- Florida Prepaid, a state college savings plan, says Salesforce's voice agent is the first point of contact for 75% of business-hours calls. Salesforce sponsored the article.

- AI-handled calls averaged about 1.6 minutes, against 10.9 minutes for staff. About 35% of chat staff moved to revenue-generating roles.
- **Our view:** "first point of contact" counts the calls the AI answers, not the calls it resolves.

Other company developments

- **Sierra:** launched two models, a voice product and a partner programme at its 6 October summit. It says almost half the Fortune 50 are customers.
- **Cresta:** says its agent-building tool, built on Anthropic's Claude Agent SDK, cuts initial deployment time "roughly in half" (5 October).
- **NiCE:** has not announced its third-quarter results date (investor page read 10 October). The reported Actimize sale talks remain unconfirmed.
- **Five9:** published no release or filing this week. Its customer event is in New York on 12 and 13 October.

What to watch

- **Customer events:** Five9 on 12 and 13 October; Observe.AI on 13 and 14 October.
- **Later in October:** the first Personal Agent Protocol specification from Sierra.
- **Lorikeet:** whether the live-schedule mode ships, and its price.
- **26 October:** Colorado's comment deadline and hearing on the automated-decision rules.
- **28 October:** Microsoft's quarterly results.
- **NiCE:** its third-quarter results date, and whether NiCE or Brookfield confirms an Actimize deal.
- **16 November:** Microsoft's sales agent starts using credits; TTEC's loan margin rises unless amended.
- **Salesforce:** the UK and EU contact-centre launch.
- **Fourth quarter:** Automation Anywhere's Boost.ai deal closes.
- **New companies surfaced, not yet tracked:** Boost.ai (chat and voice AI), Flyle (contact-centre AI agents), Meta (personal agents and business agents) and Cinareo (capacity planning, an Aspect partner).

Evidence for the next prediction check: Lorikeet's offer bears on the prediction about autonomous intraday scheduling, last assessed as weakened. It counts once the feature ships and a customer uses it.

Sources

Detailed citations

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